

Julius Felix Weiske

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Research Profile

Social scientist working at the intersection of political communication, political psychology and computational social science. Combines experimental and survey research with large-scale platform data, NLP-based text analysis and research software development. Research interests include political judgment, information integrity, democratic resilience and the societal effects of AI.

Education

M.A. Political Communication | Friedrich Schiller University Jena

Starting Oct 2026

B.A. Communication Science | Friedrich Schiller University Jena

Thesis submitted Aug 2026; final degree grade and formal award pending

Minor in Psychology (approximately 60 ECTS).

Thesis: *On the Role of Recognition of Judgment Competence: Relationality as a Factor in Ideological Bias Expression.*

- Independently developed and conducted a preregistered randomized online experiment (N = 856), from research question and study design to SoSci Survey implementation, panel fieldwork coordination, analysis and visualization.
- Applied signal detection theory, OLS/ANOVA, planned contrasts, interaction models, equivalence testing, robust inference and multiple-testing correction. Presented at *DGPs Congress 2026, Luxembourg*.

Additional studies in Sociology and Philosophy: approximately 45 ECTS at Friedrich Schiller University Jena; current average grade 1.0 (German grading scale).

Research and Professional Experience

Student Research Assistant | SensipoV, Friedrich Schiller University Jena

Oct 2024 - present

BMBF-funded project on political bias in the evaluation of scientific evidence.

- Support literature reviews, questionnaire testing, study preparation and data exports; contribute research, fact collection, testing and quality assurance to Faktomat and youth Faktomat.
- Independently set up and maintain self-hosted formr research infrastructure, including user management, updates and troubleshooting.
- Independently developed a formr fork integrating OpenAI and Anthropic chatbots into questionnaires. Designed and delivered a two-hour introductory Unipark workshop.

Research Intern and Student Research Assistant | KomRex, University of Jena

Intern: Apr 2025 - Aug 2025 | Research assistant: Aug 2025 - Mar 2026

- Led the conceptual and methodological work and writing for a first-authored contribution to *Thüringer Zustände 2026* on populist communication in the AfD's Telegram environment, with advice and support from co-authors.
- Contributed to qualitative and quantitative research, coding schemes and empirical evaluation; supported eight student science-communication projects and research-transfer workshops.
- Shared responsibility for *Resiliente Wissenschaft*, a resource addressing hostility towards researchers; supported public dialogue and science-communication events.

Publications and Conference Contributions

Weiske, J., Bojarskich, V., & Kauk, J. (2026). Im digitalen Umfeld der AfD in Thüringen - Populistische Kommunikation auf Telegram im Bundestagswahljahr 2025. In *Thüringer Zustände 2026*. [Published; first author]

Weiske, J. (accepted). Schreiben oder schreiben lassen? Eine systematische Analyse der Glaubwürdigkeitswahrnehmung von KI-Journalismus. *Licht & Wissen*. [Accepted for publication; sole author]

Weiske, J., Finn, C., Stolp, A., & Rothmund, T. (2026). Zur Rolle kommunikativer Subjektaffirmation: Relationalität als Faktor der Ideological Bias Expression. *DGPs Congress 2026, Luxembourg*. [Poster presentation]

Selected Research and Software Projects

Populist Communication on Telegram

2025 - 2026 | Lead researcher and first author

Led the research cycle from question to publication: collected approximately 80,000 messages from 101 channels; implemented preprocessing, PopBERT classification, statistical and temporal analyses, and visualization of the AfD's Thüringen communication environment.

Faktomat Live

2026 | Independent research-software project

Developed and tested an interactive application for signal-detection-based ideological bias feedback using FastAPI and JavaScript. Implemented on-device scoring, privacy thresholds, real-time aggregation, automated and load tests, and deployment configurations.

AI Journalism and Perceived Credibility

2025 - 2026 | Sole-author systematic review

Conducted systematic searching, predefined screening, PRISMA-based selection, structured coding and narrative synthesis. Used LLM-assisted extraction with manual verification and correction; accepted for publication in *Licht & Wissen*.

Twitch and Populism

2025 - 2026 | Collaborative project, currently paused

Processed approximately 970,000 transcript segments from about 22 streamers in the DACH region using Whisper ASR and PopBERT. Project paused after no sufficiently robust substantive patterns emerged.

Methods and Technical Skills

Quantitative methods: experimental and survey design; preregistration; data preparation; reliability analysis; regression and ANOVA; moderation; planned contrasts; equivalence testing; robust inference; model diagnostics; power analysis; signal detection theory, including Bayesian HMeta-d and statconfr applications.

Computational methods: platform-data collection and scraping; transformer-based text classification; automated transcription; temporal text analysis; scientific visualization.

Programming and infrastructure: Python, R, JavaScript, Bash, Git/GitHub, Linux and Docker. Practical, project-based experience; use of AI-assisted development workflows. Basic server administration.

Research tools: SoSci Survey, Unipark, formr, RStudio and Zotero.

Academic Service and Languages

Service: Peer reviewer, *Licht & Wissen* (since Jul 2026); Finance Officer, Communication Science Student Council (Oct 2023 - Sep 2024).

Languages: German (native); English (C1, scientific working proficiency); French (B1); Spanish (A1).